

Foundation One: Setting Up Your AI Workshop

THE SCHOOL OF AI | March 19, 2026 | 7:00 PM EST | 60 Minutes | Live on Zoom
Introduction to IDE fundamentals, file/folder organization, and Claude Code capabilities.

Part 1: Your AI Workshop

Three Things You Need

- 1. **Claude Code** — Your AI assistant. Lives inside the IDE, reads files, writes code, and runs commands from a single prompt.
- 2. **The IDE** — Integrated Development Environment. The shared workspace where you and AI see the same files at the same time.
- 3. **Files & Folders** — Your project structure. Claude can only work with what's in the open folder.

Section 1: What Is an IDE? (8 min)

- IDEs aren't just for developers — they're your AI workspace
- **File Explorer (Sidebar)**: Left panel for project navigation
- **Terminal (Center Area)**: Main workspace for Claude Code conversation
- **IDEs to know**: Zed (Mac), Cursor (Mac + Windows), Antigravity, VS Code (Mac + Windows)

Section 2: Folders & Files — How Claude Sees Projects (7 min)

- Project folders = containers — "everything you need is in here"
- Subfolders for organization
- File types: `.txt`, `.html`, `.md`, `.csv`

Critical Mistake: Asking Claude about files it can't see — if it's not in the folder, it's not on the workbench.

Section 3: Live Setup — Building Your Workshop (10 min)

- 1. **Account Setup** — Claude Pro (\$20/mo) or Max (\$100/mo) at [claude.ai](#)
- 2. **Node.js Installation** — Visit [nodejs.org](#) → click LTS (green button) → verify: `node --version`
- 3. **Claude Code Installation** — `npm install -g @anthropic-ai/claude-code`
- 4. **IDE Download** — Zed, Antigravity, Cursor, or VS Code
- 5. **Launch Claude Code** — Open folder → Terminal (`Ctrl + ``) → type `claude`
- 6. **First Prompts:**
 - "What files are in this folder and what are they about?"
 - "Organize these files into folders by topic and rename them"

Live Demonstrations

Demo 1: Messy Folder Cleanup

Prompt: "Look at all the files in this folder, organize them by topic into subfolders, and rename them so they make sense"

Claude reads files, creates categorized subfolders, and renames items logically.

Demo 2: Website Scrape & Rebuild

Process: Claude downloads website content/assets and creates HTML files mirroring the original site.

"Claude isn't just answering questions. It's reading, writing, and building things."

Part 2: Claude Skills

Tool Ecosystem Overview

Tool	Purpose
IDE	Workspace environment (Zed, VS Code, Cursor, Antigravity)
Claude Code	AI assistant for files & commands
Vercel	Deployment & hosting
Supabase	Database for persistent data

Node.js	Runtime environment
Git + GitHub	Version control

What Are Claude Skills? (10 min)

- Reusable instruction sets that eliminate repetitive explanations
- **Before Skills:** Multi-step manual instructions every time
- **After Skills:** Single command (e.g., `/create-social-post`)
- **Analogy:** A recipe — written once, executed consistently

How Skills Work (8 min)

1. User types command (`/skill-name`)
2. Claude reads pre-written instructions
3. Claude executes steps sequentially
4. Consistent output delivered every time

Spotting Skill Opportunities (7 min)

- **Signal 1 — Repetition:** Same instructions repeated = skill candidate
- **Signal 2 — Complexity:** 10-step recurring process = automation target
- **Signal 3 — Desire:** Wanting one-click functionality = skill indicator

Industry Examples

Industry	Skill	Input
Real Estate	<code>/generate-listing</code>	Photos + details
Marketing	<code>/create-social-post</code>	Blog articles
Finance	<code>/categorize-transactions</code>	Bank CSVs
Church	<code>/publish-sermon-notes</code>	Transcripts
Coaching	<code>/write-followup-email</code>	Session notes

Wrap-Up & Q&A (5 min)

- **Recap:** Core concepts covered
- **Homework:** Install Claude Code, open a folder, ask one question
- **Next Session Preview:** Tool integration, live builds, first skill creation
- **Q&A:** Open floor